

Paul Hayes

Group IT Director - Technology-Led Operational Scale

Transformation | PE-Backed & Multi-Site | Operating Model Design | M&A Integration
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Professional Overview

Group IT Director with 20+ years' experience designing and embedding technology-enabled operating models within complex, multi-site service and engineering organisations.

Proven track record supporting private-equity-backed growth, acquisition integration and large-scale commercial expansion.

Trusted senior leadership partner to Boards and investors, aligning technology, governance and operating structure to protect margin, reduce risk and enable sustainable scale.

Experienced in enterprise systems design, M&A integration, digital service transformation and commercial performance oversight across high-growth environments.

Accomplished in transforming business operations to drive innovation, efficiency, and growth, with core competencies in strategy, budget, team leadership, digital transformation, controls and delivery assurance.

Specialist in enterprise digital service delivery, operating model design, and service governance across complex, multi-business environments.

Career Highlights

- **Technology-Enabled Scale & Operating Model Transformation (Apogee).** Led the technology, systems, and operating model transformation that supported revenue growth from c.£6m to £300m+ (33x growth) over 10 years. Orchestrated the shift from analogue document solutions to fully digital platforms, creating scalable, resilient operations and enterprise systems still in use post-acquisition.
- **M&A Integration, Standardisation & Rapid ROI (Apogee).** Drove technology and operational integration across 14+ acquisitions in a private-equity-backed environment. Standardised infrastructure, applications, security, and delivery models, with all acquisitions, achieving ROI within just 18 months.
- **Private Equity Enablement, Governance & Market Leadership (Apogee).** Contributed at Board-level to securing private equity funding, strengthening governance and providing the platform for accelerated acquisitive growth. Helped position the business as the largest non-manufacturer supplier of digital document solutions in the UK and Europe, culminating in a corporate sale to Hewlett-Packard (HP).
- **Scaled-up a Technology-Led Services & Delivery Business (Tinder Corporation).** Founded and developed a multi-disciplined IT consultancy into a successful enterprise client-focussed services and delivery organisation.
- **Enterprise Service Governance & Risk.** Owned service governance, audit readiness, cyber assurance, and operational risk management across enterprise platforms and outsourced delivery models.

Selected Programme & Delivery Experience

- Led complex, multi-site operational and technology delivery programmes in live environments, balancing change with service continuity and commercial pressure.
- Delivered operational & technology modernisation programmes while maintaining service performance in high-availability, contract-led environments.
- Managed complex cross-functional delivery involving operations, technology, property, security, finance and external partners, ensuring clear ownership, risk control and predictable outcomes.
- Established commercial and contractual governance across managed service and offshore providers

Key Skills & Expertise

Executive Management & Strategy	Digital Transformation & Innovation	Budget Management & IT Investments
IT Operations & Service Excellence	Digital Service Operating Models	Stakeholder & Vendor Management
M&As, Post-Acquisition Integration	Service Governance, Audit & Risk	Building & Leading Teams (45-300+)
Business Growth & Cost Efficiency	Systems Performance & Scalability	Contract Negotiation & Management
Service KPIs, OKR & Performance	Outsourced & Offshore Services	Exec Stakeholder & Board Engagement

Career Experience

Tinder Corporation Ltd, Kent, UK

Founder / Head of Technology & Operations

May 2013 to Jan 2026

Founded and led a contract-led technology, telecoms and civil engineering services organisation operating across the South East, with full accountability for commercial performance, operational governance, enterprise delivery and risk management.

Directed all aspects of operating model design, financial control, service performance and enterprise systems implementation within a regulated infrastructure environment.

Took the business through the full business lifecycle including growth, diversification, operational complexity and market contraction. End-to-end responsibility for operations, finance, governance and service delivery.

Leadership, management and motivation of a 45-person organisation, including employees & contractors.

Designed & deployed ERP and operational automation, materially improving visibility, control & scalability.

Successfully-led the organisation through a period of market contraction with operational discipline, stability and stakeholder confidence.

Key contributions and successes:

- Strategic ownership of enterprise client relationships and the negotiation of contractual frameworks
- Took full commercial oversight including pricing strategy, margin control and delivery performance
- Full P&L ownership across contract-led service delivery with multi-year enterprise client frameworks.
- Scaled enterprise delivery contracts with Hyperoptic, becoming the largest S.East new-build supplier
- Designed and operationalised a new civil engineering division, achieving profitability within 8 months through disciplined cost control, workforce planning and systems integration.
- Successfully developed and on boarded a white-label revenue stream to underpin future expansion
- Completed a shareholder transition at the end of 2025, transferring ownership to business partner

Apogee Corporation

Group IT Director – PE Backed Environment

May 2006 to Jun 2013

Responsible for all elements of business technology and IT leadership within a high-growth technology services organisation during a period of rapid expansion, supporting acquisition-driven business growth.

Accountable for enterprise digital service delivery, service performance, audit readiness, and operational risk across a 300+ user estate.

Engaged as a trusted advisor during periods of rapid growth and complex change, including M&A activities. Took ownership for IT, systems and digital strategy, effectively aligning technology with business needs.

Full member of senior leadership team responsible for successful completion of 14 acquisitions, with a hands-on remit for integration readiness, systems consolidation, operational continuity, and post-deal stabilisation.

Oversaw enterprise technology budgets and capital investment aligned to acquisition strategy and growth targets.

Partnered with Board and PE stakeholders to align systems strategy with commercial value creation and exit readiness.

Successfully delivered systems integration across multiple acquisitions, supporting sustained organic growth alongside 14 national acquisitions.

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Key contributions and successes:

- Direct involvement in supporting private equity (PE) investment support and acquisition readiness
- Instrumental in business scale-up, taking the venture from approximately £6m to £300m turnover
- Designed and implemented core ERP platforms for the business, still in use post-acquisition
- Helped position the business as the largest non-manufacturer supplier of digital document solutions in the UK and Europe, culminating in a corporate sale to Hewlett-Packard (HP).

Early Career

Mar 2000 to May 2006	Head of IT / IT Analyst	Apogee Corporation
May 1999 to Feb 2000	Lead IT Consultant	Cardinal Broadcast
Feb 1996 to May 1999	Network Analyst	Xerox UK Ltd

Education

University of Greenwich	HND in Computer and Business Information Systems
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Additional Information

UK Citizen	Excellent references available	Flexible on location for the right opportunity
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